

Mariner High School

French I Course Syllabus 2018-2019

Instructor: Janet Wheeler

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Course Overview and Objectives

French One helps students to develop listening, reading, speaking, and writing skills to communicate in elementary French. Oral communication is emphasized and practiced. Students will acquire knowledge of, develop a respect for, and demonstrate an appreciation for the different culture of the Francophone world resulting from exposure to its customs, geography, literature and arts. This cultural awareness, combined with the foreign language skills initiated in this course, will enable students to function more successfully in the diverse global community. This course correlates to the vision of developing life-long learners who have a sense of global citizenship, can communicate with people within their own community and throughout the world, and can use technology to enhance these goals.

Credit: 1.0 Elective/World Language

Students in French I will articulate potential answers to these questions:

1. How does someone interact, understand, and be understood by a Francophone person?
2. In what ways do French speakers express concepts such as: greetings; numbers, calendar & time; descriptions of family, friends & surroundings; likes/dislikes & daily activities; and wishes & abilities -- differently from English speakers, both orally and in written form?
3. How do history, geography, and contemporary life affect French culture and language?
4. What do French grammatical structures, language and culture teach us about our own?
5. How do French communities and their customs compare to one another and our own and what does this signify?
6. With or without technology, why is communication and understanding between diverse communities important?
7. What is the role of the individual in the global community?

Materials Used

Student Materials required:

SPIRAL NOTEBOOK
Loose-leaf paper
Pencil, pen, highlighters

Also recommended:

3-ring binder (for handouts and HW)
3x5 notecards, scissors, colored pencils & pens
French/English Pocket Dictionary

Texts

D'Accord 1 (Vista Higher Learning, 2014)

Supplementary: Dis-Moi (Scott, Foresman, 1990)

Transparencies, activities, videos, and audio tapes supplied by publisher and instructor.

Numerous activities and resources will also be accessed at vhlcentral.com

Grading Procedures/Evaluation

Students earn points daily, for both written and oral practice. Students are assessed on material regularly (through composition, exam, or project) and at the end of each unit (approximately 2 per quarter). Assignments are given the following categories, which in turn are weighted to calculate students' cumulative grades:

Participation/Attendance = 20% (Being in class, on time, listening, and responding, etc)
Daily Assignments = 30%
Assessments = 40%
Culture Points = 10%

Homework Expectations

Assignments given as homework are expected to be completed on time. To receive full credit, the assignment must be completed and turned in AT THE BEGINNING of the period on the due date. Late assignments lose 10% credit per day.

Culture Points are an ongoing assignment, which students are expected to complete outside of class and turn in *throughout* the semester. These points may be earned in a variety of ways, and parent involvement is encouraged. Unlike daily work, final dates for submitting Culture Points are non-negotiable.

Students may earn extra credit in several ways. Extra credit is frequently offered on tests & quizzes, and is often rewarded on projects and assignments where a student has performed well above expectations.

Testing Procedures

Students are expected to prepare thoroughly for tests and quizzes. However, if a student is not satisfied with the results of a test or quiz, he may retest, before or after school by appt. Before this retest, the student should arrange a study session with the teacher or a tutor. The score earned on this retest will replace the original grade, to a maximum of 85%.

On occasion, students will be given take-home tests. In this case, tests must be turned in at the beginning of the period. No late take-home tests are accepted.

Attendance and Make up Work

Participation, which is 20% of a student's cumulative grade, is directly affected by attendance.

Tardies: Being late to class hinders a student's ability to participate fully in class, and therefore a student loses participation points for every time s/he is tardy. In addition, a student will be assigned detention for every 3 tardies.

Absences: When a student is absent, s/he must make the effort to make up the work missed in a reasonable amount of time. Students should check the Website Homework Page following any absence:

- Excused Absence: If a student misses a test or quiz, s/he should take the test or turn in the assignment within 3 days of returning to class. If a student misses a due date for a long-term asst, s/he is expected to turn it in upon the day of return. Any student who requires more time as a result of excused absences should discuss needs with the instructor, and will then be given extra consideration for an extended due date.
- Unexcused Absence: Any student coming to class having excused an absence will not be allowed additional time for making up work. If an absence is left unresolved, any work or tests missed during the absence will earn 0 credits. No participation points may be made up.
- Field Trips/School Events/Appointments: Whenever possible, work is due before the event or immediately upon return. Otherwise, the student and instructor will agree upon the work to be completed during or after the absence. Participation points for the day will not be affected when prior notice is given.

Credit can be lost if absences exceed 12 per semester (per District Policy)

Grading Scale

To determine a student's cumulative semester grade, quarter percentages are averaged using the following scale:

A 100-94%	C+ 79-77%	F below 60% (no credit)
A- 93-90%	C 76-74%	
B+ 89-87%	C- 73-70%	INC (when a majority of projects/papers cannot be assessed due to unusual circumstances. Can only be given with Administration approval)
B 86-84%	D+ 69-67%	
B- 83-80%	D 66-60%	

Academic Dishonesty

Students are expected to complete their own work. If a student is having difficulty completing an assignment on time, s/he is encouraged to seek help from the instructor or from peers, but copying others' work is forbidden. If a student's work is copied from another student's, *both* students shall receive 0 for that assignment.

Students are also reminded that their work is assessed according to the language acquisition goals/objectives of the unit and level. In other words, students should not rely on translation resources to compose their written work. Students are generally discouraged from composing in English first, then trying to translate. *Using translation resources instead of composing one's own work in French is considered academic dishonesty.* First offense = warning with chance to make up. Second offense = 0 for the assignment + conference. Continued abuse of translation resources will result in administrative referral and disciplinary action.

Classroom Expectations

Students are expected to:

1. Come to class prepared to learn with spiral notebook, textbook, and assignments in hand.
2. Take an active part in classroom activities.
3. Be attentive during instruction and follow directives conscientiously.
4. Remove obstacles to communicative practice: refrain from eating, chewing gum, listening to headphones, using personal electronic devices, violating dress code policy, and using offensive language.
5. Respect others' property, feelings, opinions, and right to learn: refrain from interfering with or distracting from instruction and activity.

Failure to maintain these standards will result in one or all of the following: verbal warning, student/teacher conference, loss of Participation Points, and contact with Advisor and/or parents. Repeated offenses may result in parent conference, administrative intervention, and removal from class.

Additional Assistance

French I students are encouraged to use the expertise of upper-level students for additional help, either formally or informally. Peer tutoring may also be available school wide. In addition, students are encouraged (or specifically invited) to get extra help from Ms. Wheeler outside of class before or after school.

A variety of language acquisition programs are available on-line and in bookstores for further enrichment. See Ms. Wheeler's website for a list of on-line resources.